

Apartment Walkthrough Photo Checklist

Do this **on move-in day** (and again before move-out). Photos beat memory.

Rules

1. Lights on. Daytime if you can.
2. Wide shot, then close-up of every defect.
3. Include a timestamp (phone clock in-frame or metadata).
4. Upload to cloud **before** you lose the phone.

Address / unit: _____

Move-in date: _____ Manager: _____

Whole-home

- ☐ Front door / locks / keys tested
- ☐ Smoke + CO detectors present (note missing)
- ☐ HVAC filter condition / thermostat works
- ☐ Windows open/lock; screens intact
- ☐ Closets: rods, shelves, damage
- ☐ Floors: scratches, stains, soft spots
- ☐ Walls / ceilings: holes, stains, cracks
- ☐ Outlets / switches spot-check each room

Kitchen

- ☐ Sink / disposal / shutoffs
- ☐ Fridge / freezer temps (or at least runs)
- ☐ Stove / oven / range hood
- ☐ Dishwasher (run a short cycle if possible)
- ☐ Cabinets / drawers / counters chips
- ☐ Under-sink water stains

Bath

- ☐ Toilet secure / runs / leaks
- ☐ Tub/shower caulk, mold, drain speed
- ☐ Fan works
- ☐ Vanity / mirror / moisture damage

Each bedroom / living area

- ☐ Carpet vs pad smells / stains
- ☐ Door latch / closet
- ☐ Ceiling fan wobble / lights

Photo log (defects)

#	Location	Issue	Photo taken?	Reported?
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1			[]	[]
2			[]	[]
3			[]	[]
4			[]	[]
5			[]	[]

Send / save

- ☐ Email photo set to yourself + manager (if required)
- ☐ Keep copy offline
- ☐ Note meter readings if needed: electric _____ gas _____

Move-out mirror

Re-walk this list. Clean to the standard in your lease. Compare to move-in photos before the final walkthrough.

Buckeye Trail Guide · Curated by Keith Householder · Columbus, Ohio
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